# A world with a history

Established humans at the start. Changing opportunities, cultures and populations afterward.

## The starting point

World Year 0 represents established **Homo sapiens** around the equivalent of 200,000 years ago. Other hominin lineages have their own connected ancestral dispersal, isolation, physical traits and ancestry. There are no invented states or universal calendar-based technology unlocks.

## What the model tracks

| | |
|---|---|
| **Climate and ecology** | Stable ecological boundaries; changing temperature, rain, ice, vegetation potential and local species presence. Wet corridors, refugia and real shelf depths affect movement. |
| **People and resources** | Age structure, births, deaths, food, winter protection, mating contacts and local shocks. Populations can retreat or disappear. Splitting a population record creates no extra food access. |
| **Technology** | 43 techniques with separate familiarity, trained prevalence and actual use. Prerequisites, materials, teachers, innovation and forgetting matter. Useful technologies spread through real contact. |
| **Language** | Inherited words and grammar change at different rates. Borrowing, bilingual contact, local varieties and recognisable families are separate from deep common ancestry. |
| **Culture and belief** | Distinct social norms, exchange relationships and residence patterns. Local rites, sacred places/animals, mortuary practices and spiritual themes vary and spread without churches or states. |
| **Human lineages** | Different body/face profiles, cultural capacities, geographic histories and mixed ancestry. Competition and survival depend on actual conditions; extinction is not scheduled by date. |
| **Local inhabitants** | Stable bands, households, birthdays, parents, seasonal camps and contacts. Samples contain actual proficient makers, individual language knowledge and separate routine/winter equipment. |

# How this reaches the game

The simulation produces local evidence for the next supervised NPC implementation.

## From a district to a camp

A local query supplies a band, related people, appearance, spoken languages, capable craft specialists, equipment practices and a seasonal itinerary. The NPC host must retain instantiated people and player edits. Camp candidates still need physical ground, water and collision validation.

## Observe the actual differences

Language/family, cultural identity, spiritual tradition, toolkit and human-species layers read different data. Political territories remain empty. Climate/ecology maps follow the dated world. Technology inspection distinguishes knowing a method, being able to make it and routinely using it.

## World continuity and performance

Small demographic reviews and slower network/ecology reviews share one saved timeline. Long histories remain computationally expensive. Nearby queries use district/contact indexes. Terrain workers read the exact planet without duplicating the population archive; dated local-map colours stay with the player.

## Use a new world or restart its simulation

New worlds use the corrected **foragers-3** resource rules. Existing saves retain their older model for reproducible continuation. Compact saves preserve every historical field; earlier save formats remain readable. Old source and required assets remain restorable through Git and the asset packs.

## Validation and scope

Check several seeds and dates, expansion and retreat, local technique differences, real vocabulary divergence, household consistency, save/reload, live map playback and entering gameplay. Physical NPC camps/dialogue, new hominin art, moving shorelines/ice-sheet terrain and post-Paleolithic progression are separate implementation stages.

## Selected research behind the mechanisms

Structured African ancestry and connected populations

Climate, habitats and hominin distributions

Forager networks and cumulative culture

Language change: unequal rates across features

Forager belief systems and their variation

Culture-linked competition and assimilation